WAKE COUNTY
PUBLIC SCHOOL SYSTEM

School Forms

Admin Guide

Wake County Public School System
October 2026

For Administrator accounts

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1. Getting started

1.1 What an administrator can do

An administrator account can do everything a staff member can, plus the work that shapes what everyone else sees. In practice that means:

- **Design and publish forms** — the questions parents answer, and the staff-only fields your staff fill in.
- **Decide who can see what** — public or private forms, which roles see which staff-only field, and which menu items each role gets.
- **Manage accounts and roles** — create users, reset passwords, and define what a role may do.
- **Work the submissions grid** — filter and search across schools, edit a staff-only field in one cell or across an entire column, and export what you see.
- **Watch the plumbing** — the Webhook Log shows every response Google Forms sent, including the ones the app rejected.

> **This guide and the Settings Reference**
>
> Day-to-day work — forms, submissions, reports, access — is in this guide. The **twelve Settings sections** are in the companion Settings Reference, one chapter per section. Both are printable and use the same conventions.

1.2 Signing in

Open the School Forms address and sign in with the email address and password for your administrator account.

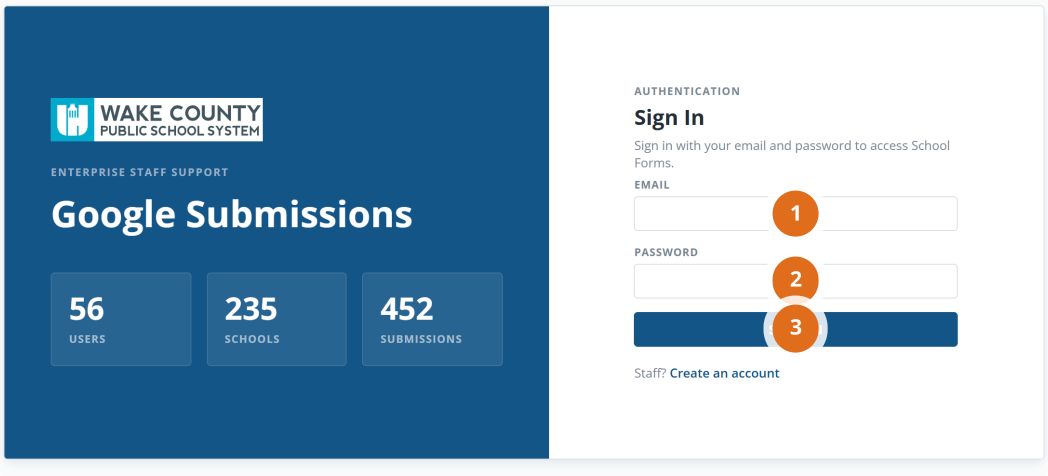


Figure 1 — Signing in.

1. **Email** — your administrator address.
2. **Password** — your password.
3. **Sign In**.

> **If the screen looks different**
>
> An administrator controls the sign-in mode in **Settings** → **Login Mode**. If you see **Organization** and **Test User** lists instead of the two boxes, the installation is in test mode; if you see an amber maintenance message, sign-in is switched off. See the Settings Reference, chapter 3.

1.3 Finding your way around

You land on **Submissions**. The menu is closed so your work has the full width of the screen — click the menu button in the top-left corner.

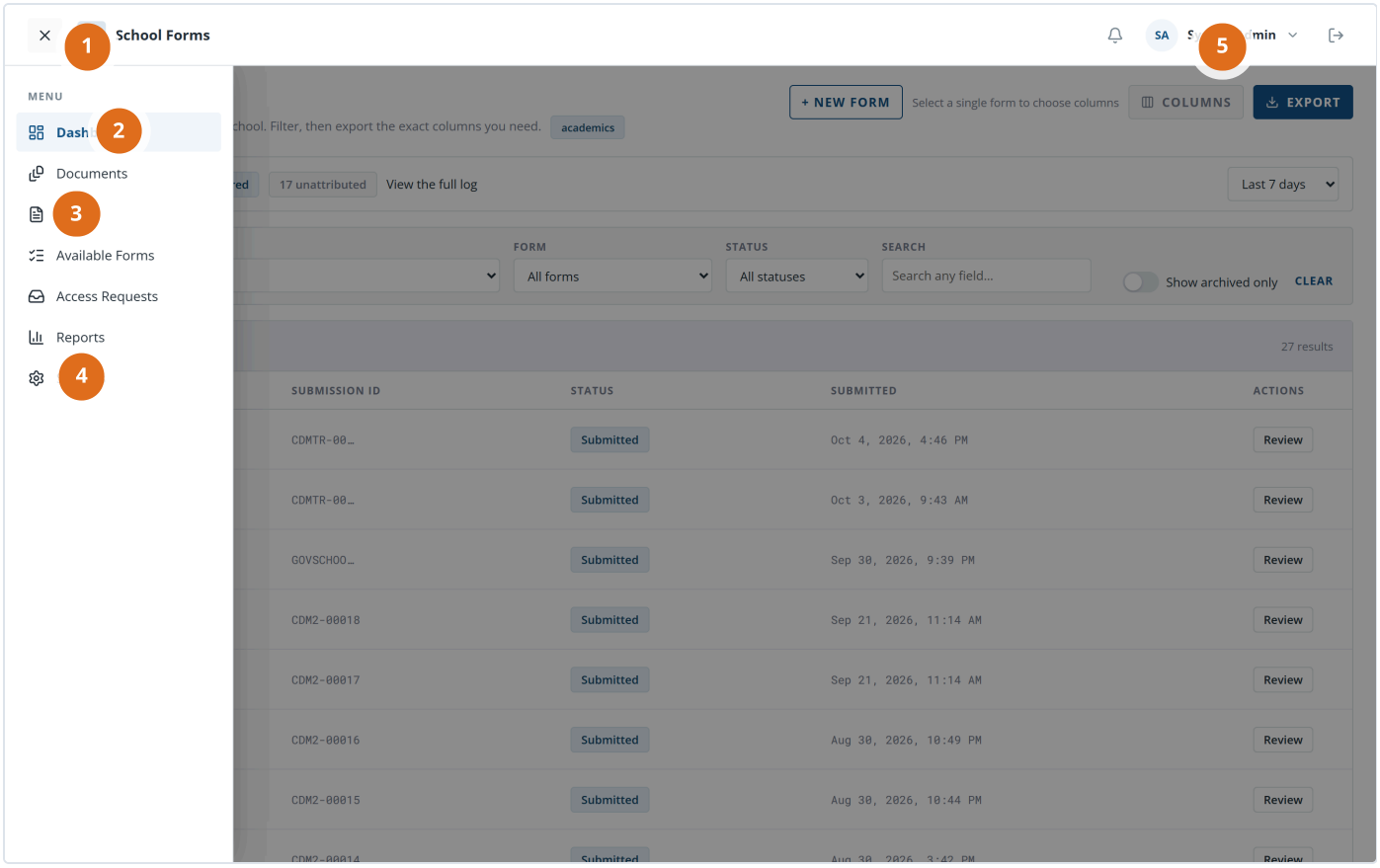


Figure 2 — The administrator menu.

1. Menu button.
2. **Dashboard** — every submission in your organization.
3. **Forms** — the form list and the designer.
4. **Settings** — the twelve sections in the companion Settings Reference.
5. Your account chip — opens **Change password**.

Between **Forms** and **Settings** sit **Documents**, **Available Forms**, **Access Requests** and **Reports**; **Documents** appears only when enabled for your role.

> **Menu items can be hidden**
>
> **Forms**, **Available Forms**, **Access Requests** and **Reports** are each switchable per role in **Settings** → **Menu Settings**. If a colleague cannot see one, that is a setting, not a fault. **Settings** itself is always available to administrators.

2. Submissions

2.1 The dashboard

The **Dashboard** lists every submission across every school in your organization.

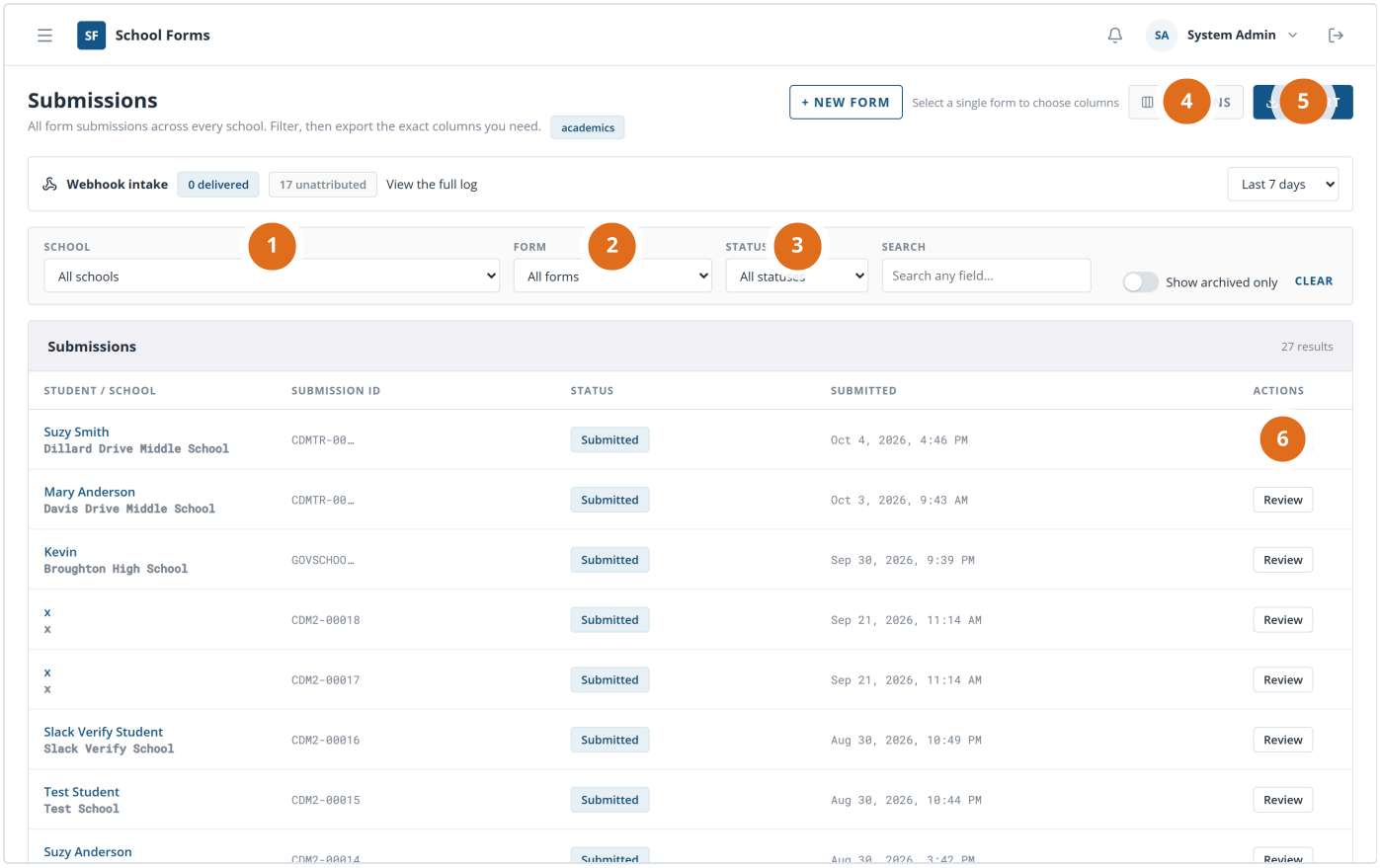


Figure 3 — The submissions dashboard.

1. **School** — all schools or one.
2. **Form** — all forms or one; picking one adds its fields as columns.
3. **Status** — Submitted, In Review, Flagged, Completed.
4. **Columns** — choose which fields appear.
5. **Export** — download what you see.
6. **Review** — opens the submission. The student's name does the same.

A **Search** box and a **Search in** column selector sit beside the three dropdowns.

2.2 Filtering and searching

Narrow the grid with the four filters in the bar. **Clear** resets every filter, including the form.

- **Search** matches any answer on the row. Use **Search in** to restrict it to one column — for example, a course name in *Course choice #1* only.
- Picking a **Form** is what makes that form's fields available as columns and as search targets.
- Staff-only columns sort to the right-hand end and are tinted. You can edit them in place, exactly as staff do — or edit a whole column at once, see 2.3.

> **Archived submissions are hidden by default**
>
> An archived submission disappears from this grid, from exports, from reports and from the documents list. It is not deleted — see 2.5 for restoring it.

2.3 Editing a staff-only column in bulk

When the same staff-only field has to be filled in for many submissions — a course placement, a letter that went out, a checkbox for every student in a batch — you do not have to open the cells one at a time. Pick the form first, then edit the whole column and save it in one go.

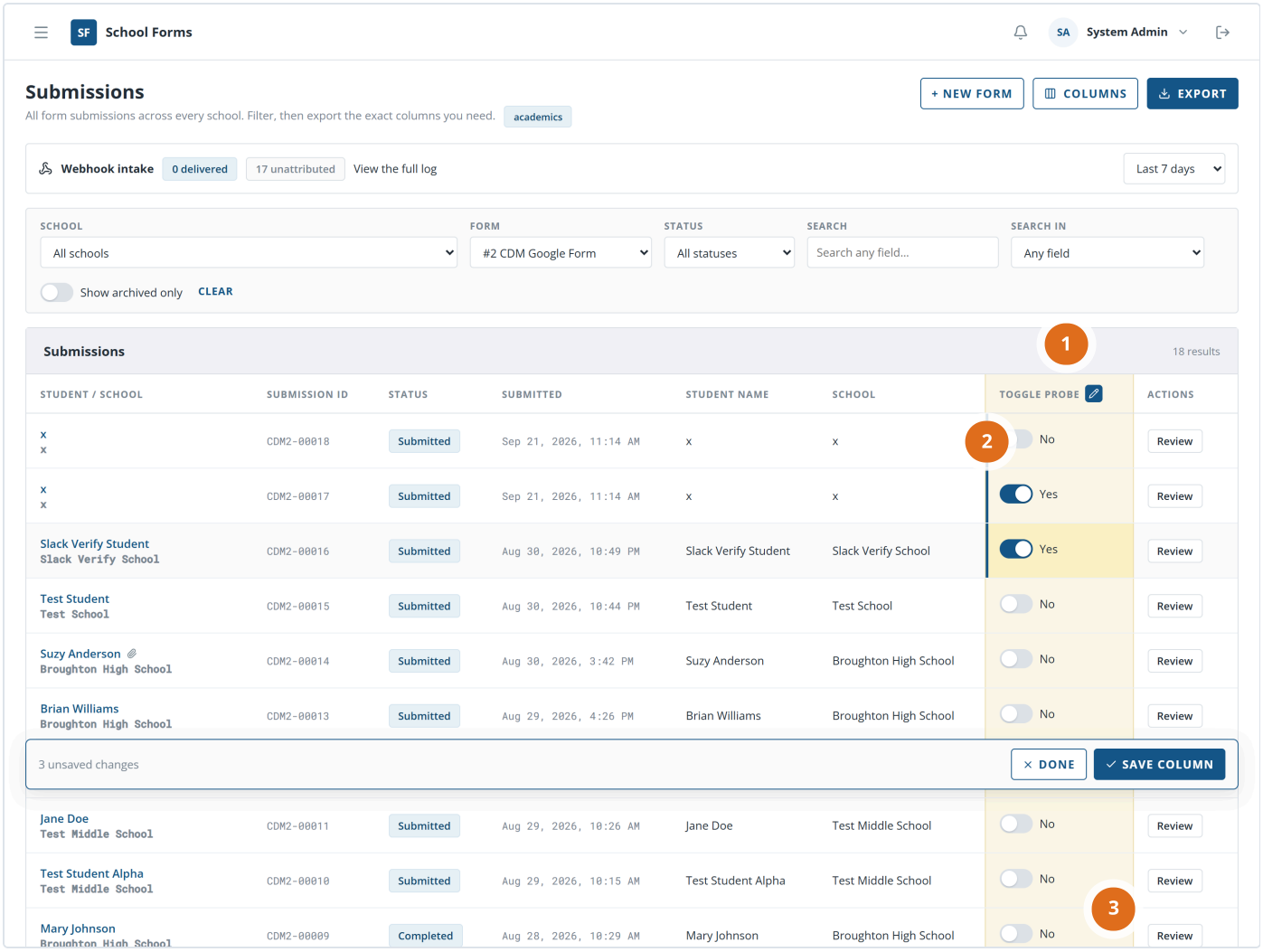


Figure 4 — Editing a whole staff-only column.

1. The **pencil** in a staff-only column's header — it appears when you hover the header, or when you tab to it.
2. Every cell in the column becomes a control: a switch, a dropdown, a text box, or a **Choose** button for a field with several options.
3. The save bar: how many changes are waiting, **Done** to leave, and **Save column** to write them all.

A changed cell gets a blue bar down its left edge, so you can see what is still unsaved while you scroll.

1. Choose the **Form** and any filters you want. The column covers exactly the rows on screen — so if you have filtered to one school or one status, only those rows are written.
2. Hover a staff-only column's header and click the **pencil**. The header turns solid blue while the column is open.
3. Change as many rows as you like. Nothing is saved yet — the bar counts the changes.

4. Click **Save column**. One save writes every changed row, and each row records you as the person who last changed its staff-only fields — the same audit line a single-cell edit writes.
5. Click **Done** to leave the column. If changes are still waiting, you are asked to confirm before they are discarded.

Only staff-only columns can be edited this way

The pencil appears on staff-only columns only. A parent's answers are never written in bulk — those are corrected one at a time, on the submission page.

A row that cannot be saved does not undo the others

If a submission was archived, moved to another school, or deleted while you were editing, it is skipped and named in the bar — everything else is still saved. Your changes to the skipped rows are kept, so you can look at them and try again.

2.4 Exporting

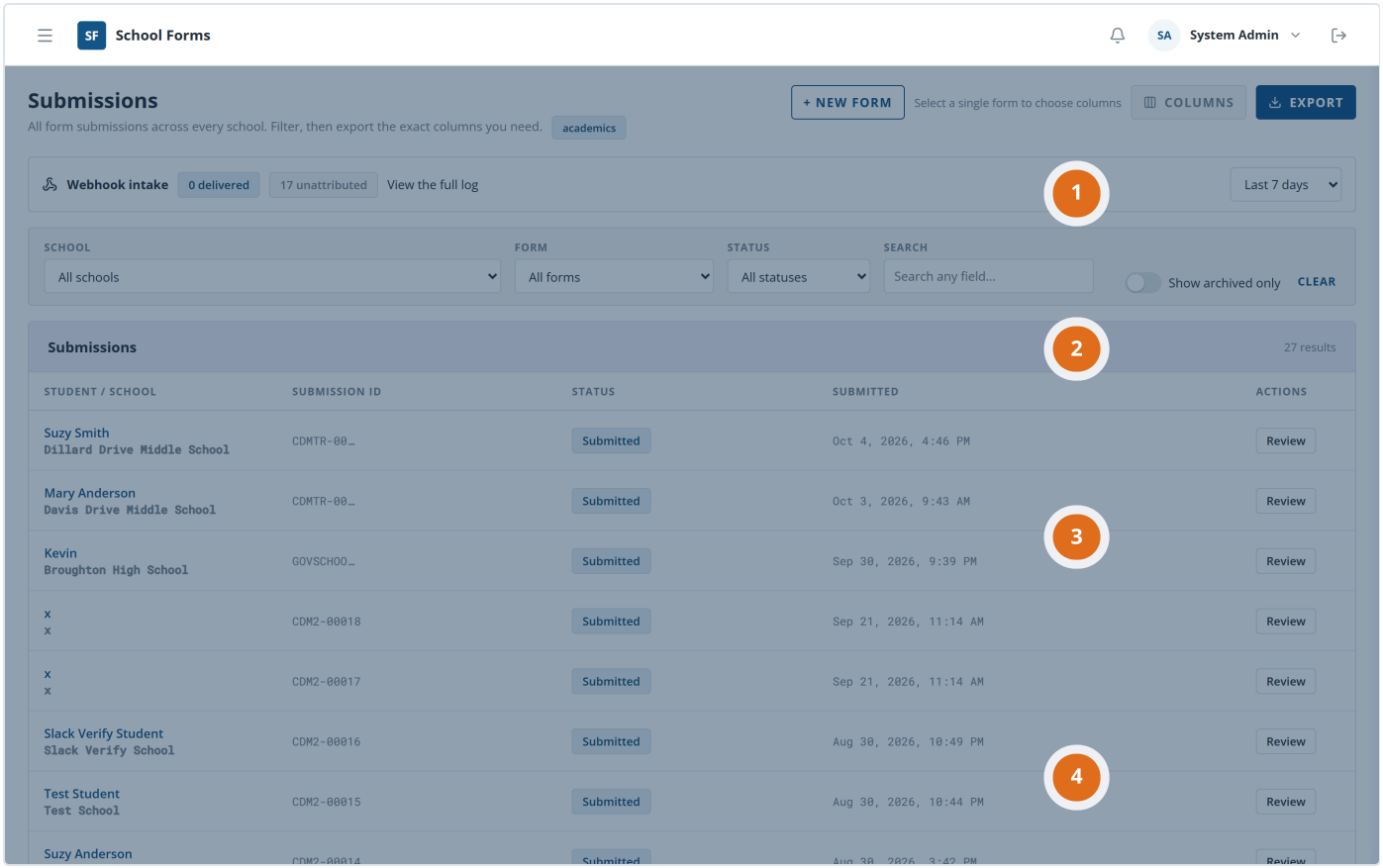


Figure 5 — Exporting from the dashboard.

1. How many rows and columns the file will hold.
2. Tick the columns to include.
3. A preview of the first rows.
4. **Export CSV**.

The file downloads as `submissions-export.csv`. For Excel or PDF, or to save the setup for next time, use Reports instead.

2.5 Reviewing and archiving a submission

Click a student's name or **Review** to open the submission. The page is the same one staff use, with two additions only an administrator sees:

- **Delete permanently** — appears on an *archived* submission only, and cannot be undone. The dialog names the student and states that the generated Google Doc itself is *not* deleted, only the app's link to it.
- **Promote to form field** — on the **Additional fields** card, when a Google Form asked a question that was never defined in the designer. Promoting it adds a real field to the form and migrates every matching answer.

Everything else — **Select Status**, **Edit** for a parent's answers, **Save staff fields**, **Archive** and **Restore** — works exactly as described in the Staff Guide, Part 5.

3. Forms

3.1 The Forms list

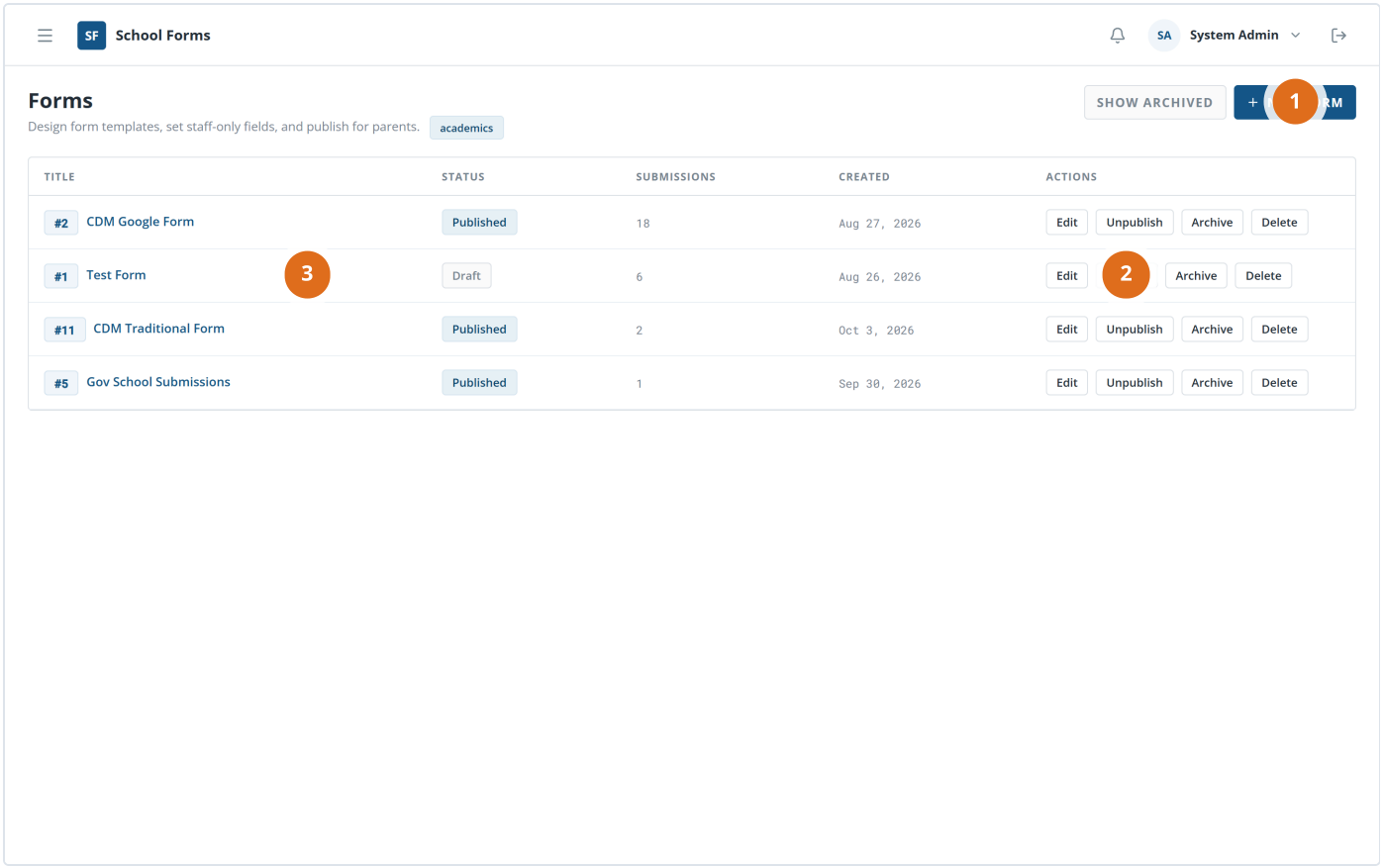


Figure 6 — The Forms list.

1. **New Form** — opens the create card (Figure 6).
2. The per-row action buttons: **Design**, **Publish**/**Unpublish**, **Archive**/**Restore**, and **Delete**.
3. The form's number and title. The number is what an Apps Script is configured with.

> **Delete is disabled once a form has submissions**
>
> That is deliberate: submission data is never lost to a mis-click. To retire a form that has been used, **Archive** it instead — it stops accepting submissions and every submission is kept.

3.2 Creating a form

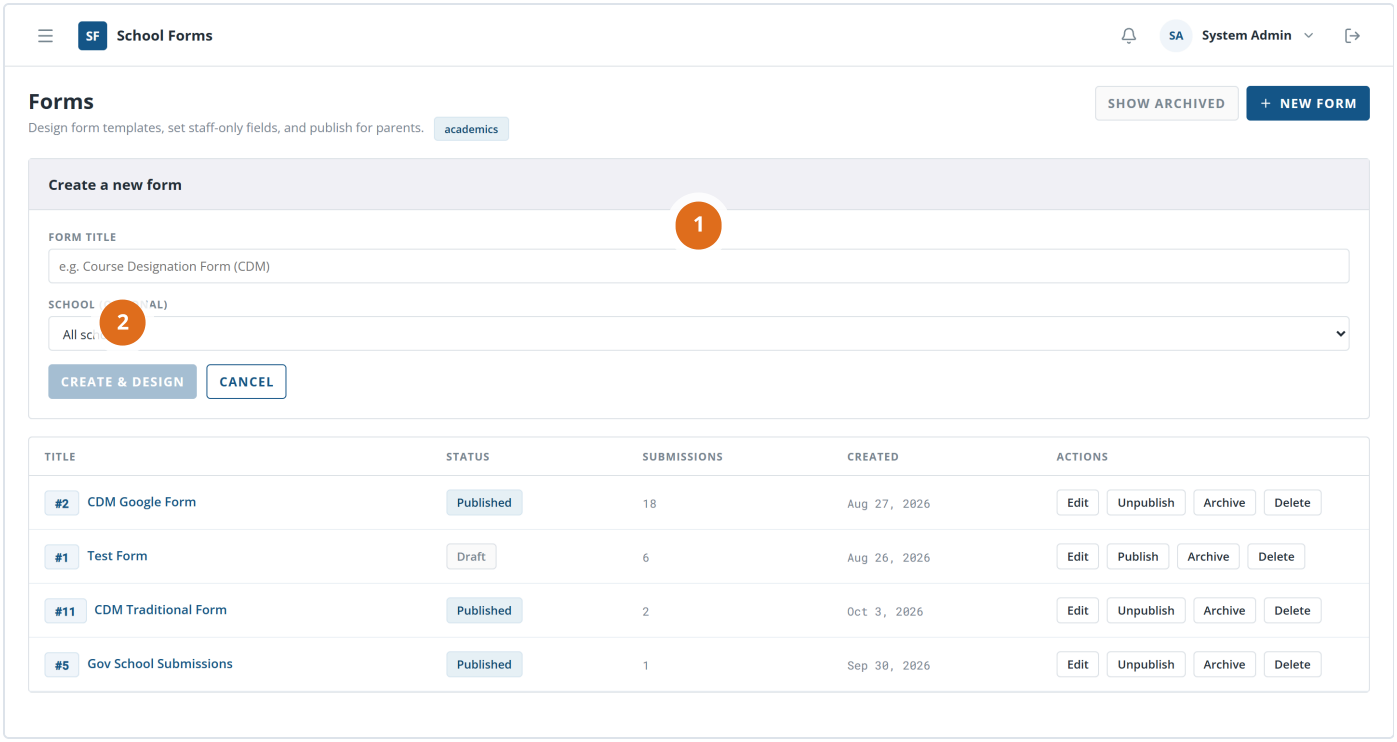


Figure 7 — Creating a form.

1. The **title** — for example *Course Designation Form (CDM)*.
2. **Create & Design** saves it as a Draft and opens the designer.

The card is opened by **New Form** on the Forms list.

3.3 Form Details

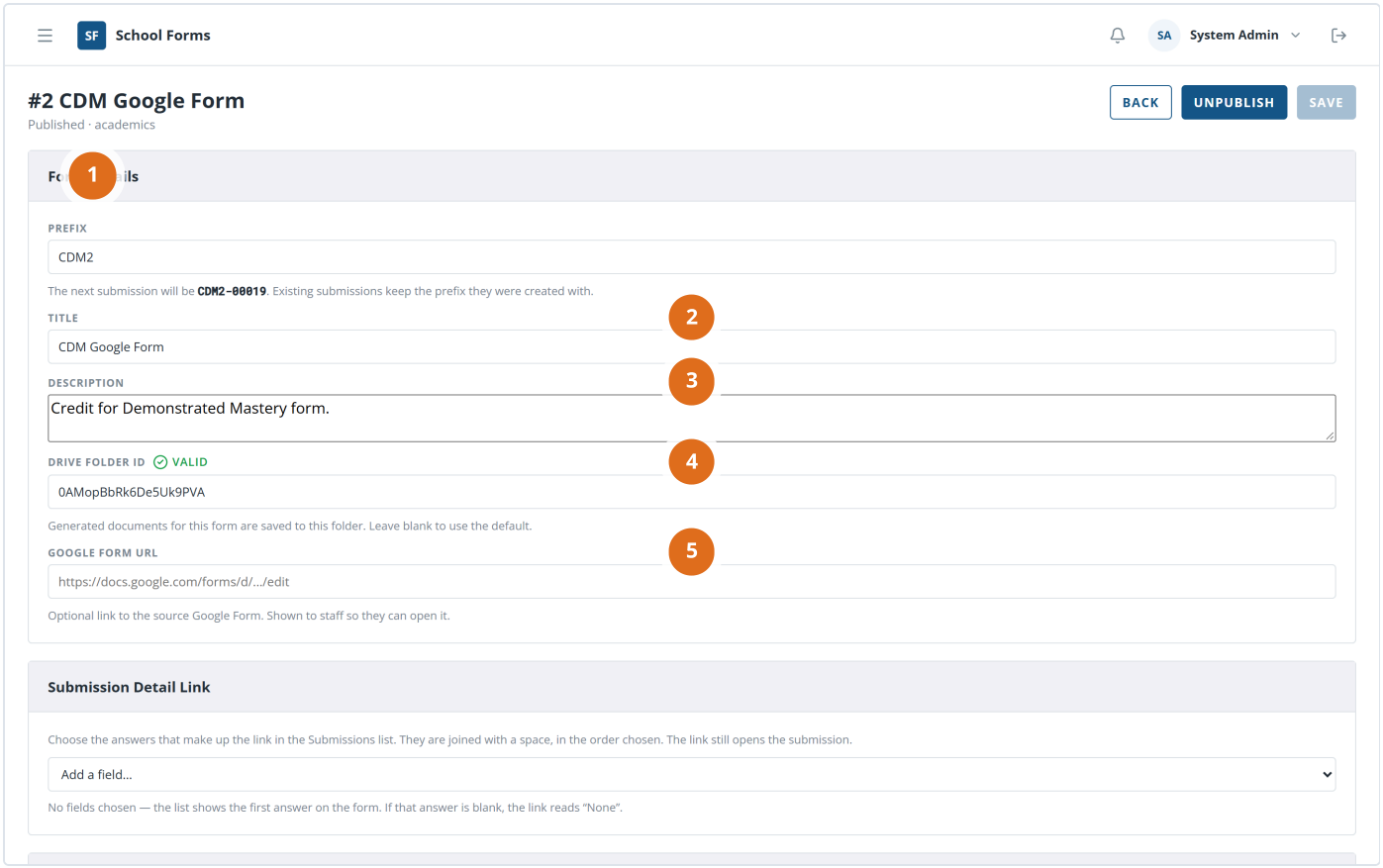


Figure 8 — The Form Details card.

1. The **Form Details** card.
2. **Title** — shown to parents and staff.
3. **Description** — an optional note shown to parents.
4. **Drive Folder ID** — where generated documents are saved. A green **Valid** check means the folder is reachable.
5. **Google Form URL** — an optional link shown to staff. Nothing is fetched from it; it is information only.

Publish / **Unpublish** sits in the page header, above this card.

> **There is no "generate fields from Google Form"**
>
> The Google Form URL is a link for staff to follow. Fields are always built by hand in the designer. A question a Google Form asks that the designer does not define is still captured on the submission and can be promoted later — see 2.5.

3.4 Adding fields

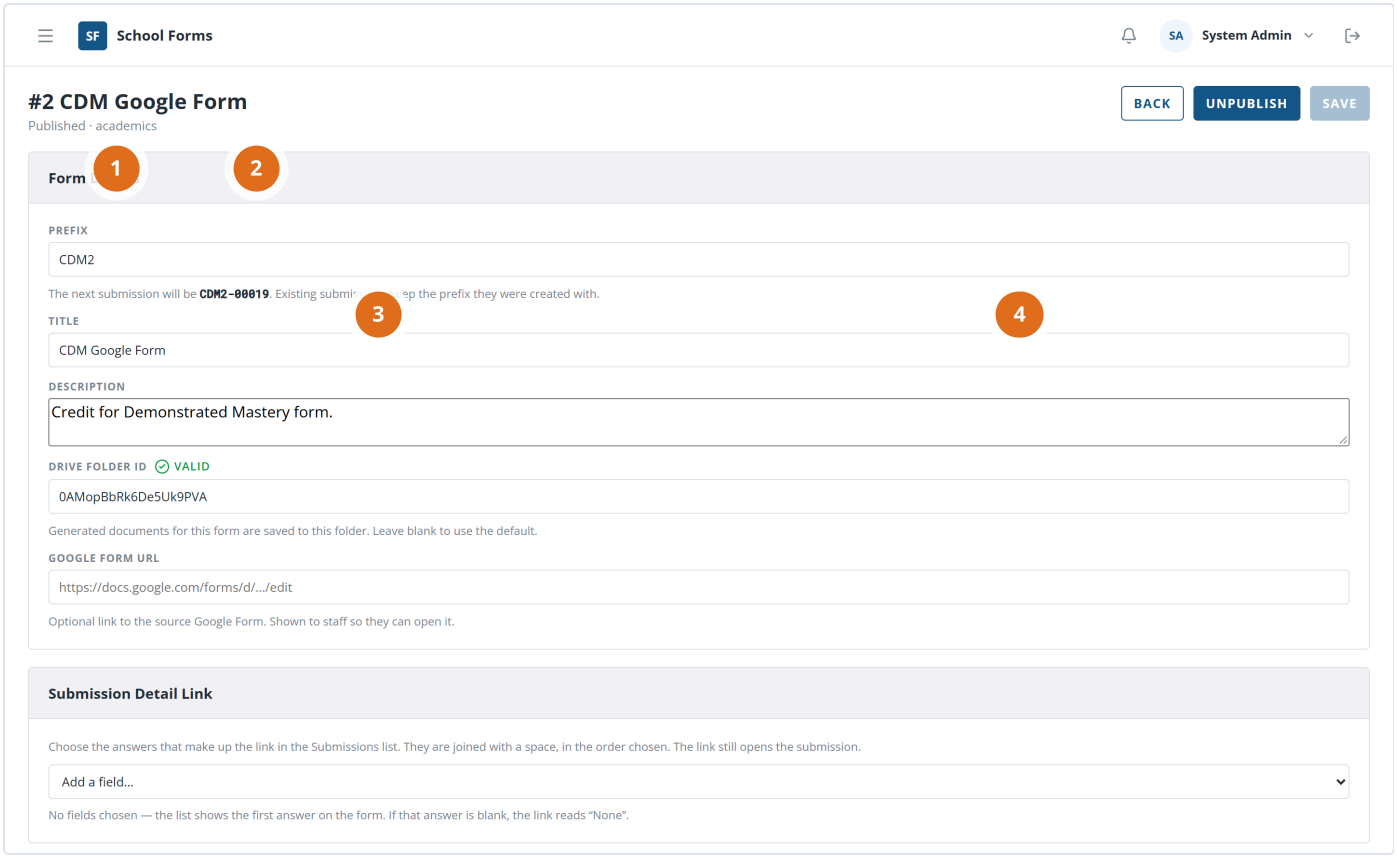


Figure 9 — Building the parent-facing fields.

1. **Form Fields** — the questions parents answer.
2. **Staff Only Fields** — the tab for fields parents never see (Figure 9).
3. **Label** — the question text.
4. **Type** — Text, Text Area, Number, Date, Email, Google Document, Select, Radio, Checkbox or Toggle.

Each row also carries **Options** (comma-separated, for Select, Radio and Checkbox only), a **Required** switch, arrows to reorder, and ✕ to remove. **Add Form Field** sits below the last row.

3.5 Staff-only fields and access

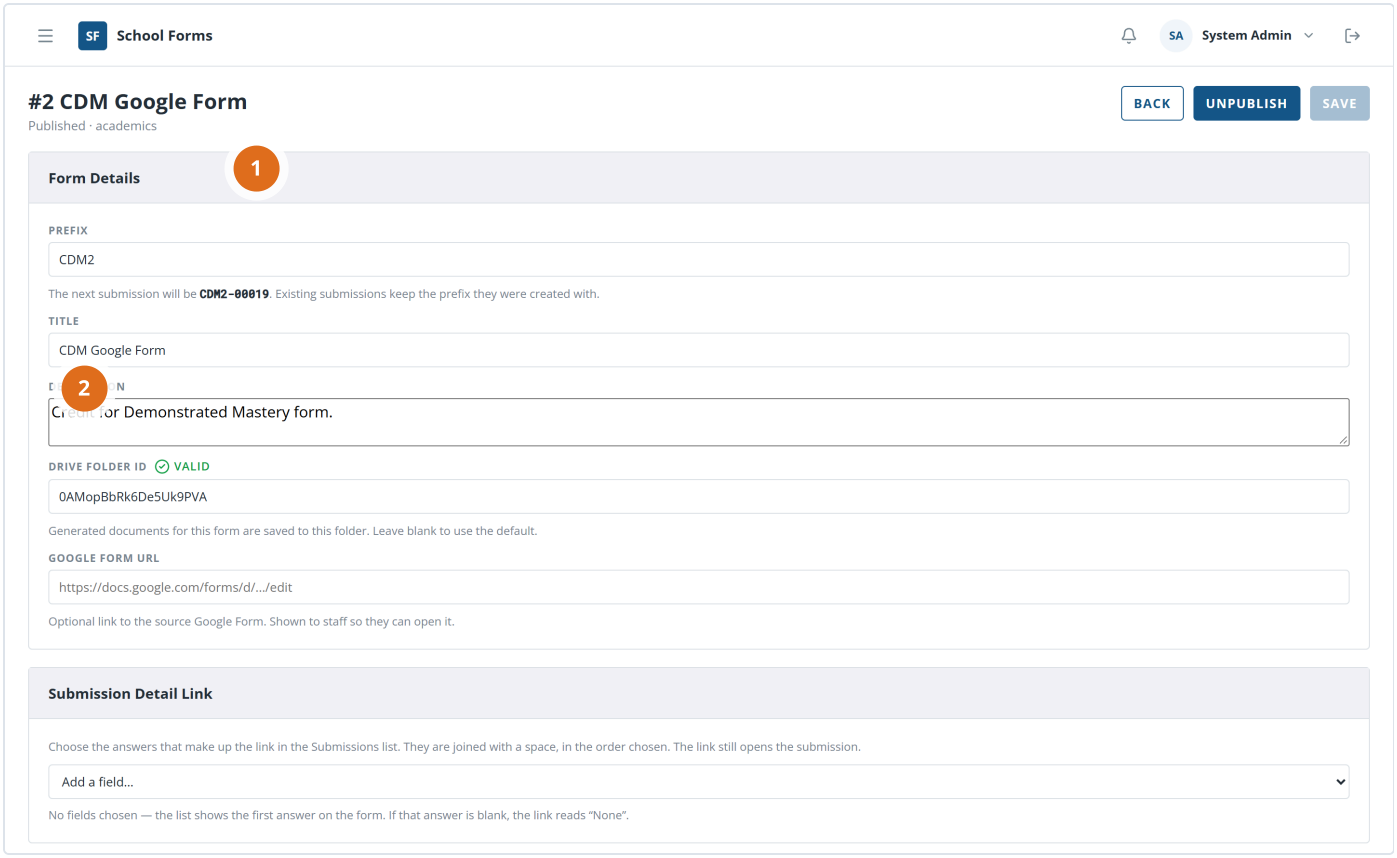


Figure 10 — Staff-only fields and their Access row.

1. The **Staff Only Fields** tab, with a count of how many exist.
2. The **Access** row under each field: one button per role. A filled button (**✓ Staff**) means that role can see and fill the field; an outlined one (**+ Staff**) means it cannot. Click to toggle.

A staff-only field has the same **Label**, **Type** and **Options** as a form field. Its **Required** switch is off by default, because a staff-only field is normally filled in later rather than by the parent.

> **Why the Access row matters**
>
> This is how you keep a field visible to Administrators only, or to Administrators and School Contacts but not Staff. A role created later starts with no access to existing staff-only fields until you grant it here.

3.6 Visibility: public and private

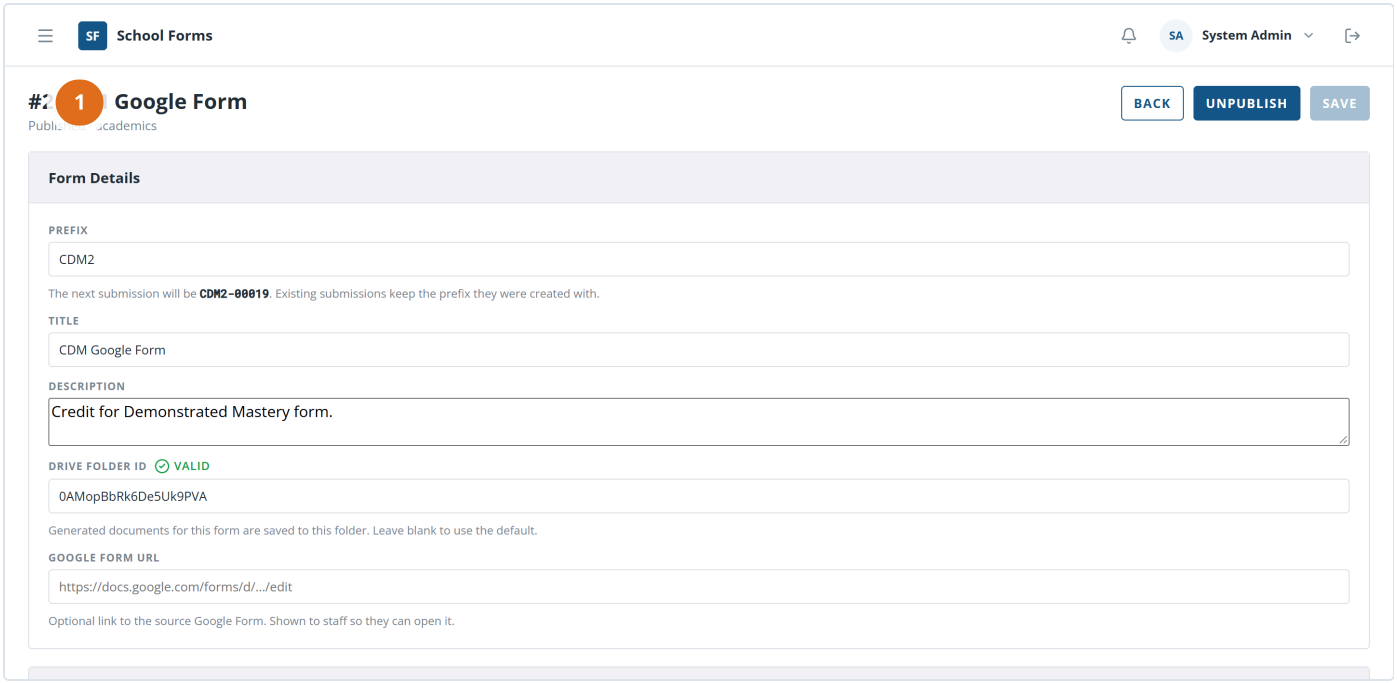


Figure 11 — Choosing who can open the form.

1. The **Visibility** card. It offers **Public** — every account in the organization can read the form — and **Private**, where an account sees it only after you grant access in **Settings** → **Users** or by approving a request.

Changing a published form to private asks you to confirm first, because it takes the form away from everyone who was relying on it.

3.7 Staff attachments

The Attachments card

At the bottom of the designer is an **Attachments** card. It replaces the old *Public link* card, which is no longer shown.

1. **Enable Staff Attachments** — the switch that turns the feature on for this form. It is **off for every form** until you turn it on, and it stays disabled until the form has a **Drive Folder ID**.
2. **Access** — one button per role. A filled button (**✓ Staff**) means that role can add and see files on a submission; an outlined one (**+ Staff**) means it cannot. Administrators always can. Turning the switch off does *not* clear these choices, so switching it back on restores them.

Files are saved to the form's Drive folder under `Attachments/<submission id>/`, named `<submission id> - <file name>`. Up to **10 files per submission**, of any type. There is no size limit in the app, but very large files (long video or audio) can fail on a slow connection — the page says so when it happens.

Where staff see it

On a submission, the **Attachments** card sits directly below the **Staff-only fields** card. Staff click **+ Attachment** to upload and the files are listed underneath. An administrator or the person who uploaded a file can remove it. Deleting the submission removes the record but leaves the files in Drive.

Settings → Attachments

Settings has an **Attachments** panel that sets the *default* roles for every form. A form's own Access row overrides it. The panel does not turn the feature on — each form still needs its **Enable Staff Attachments** switch.

Unpublishing keeps existing submissions

Unpublish stops the form accepting new responses; everything already submitted is untouched. Responses that arrive while a form is unpublished are rejected and recorded in the Webhook Log — publishing the form again makes them deliverable.

4. Access requests

When a form is private, an account that cannot read it can ask for access. Those requests arrive here, and in the bell in the banner.

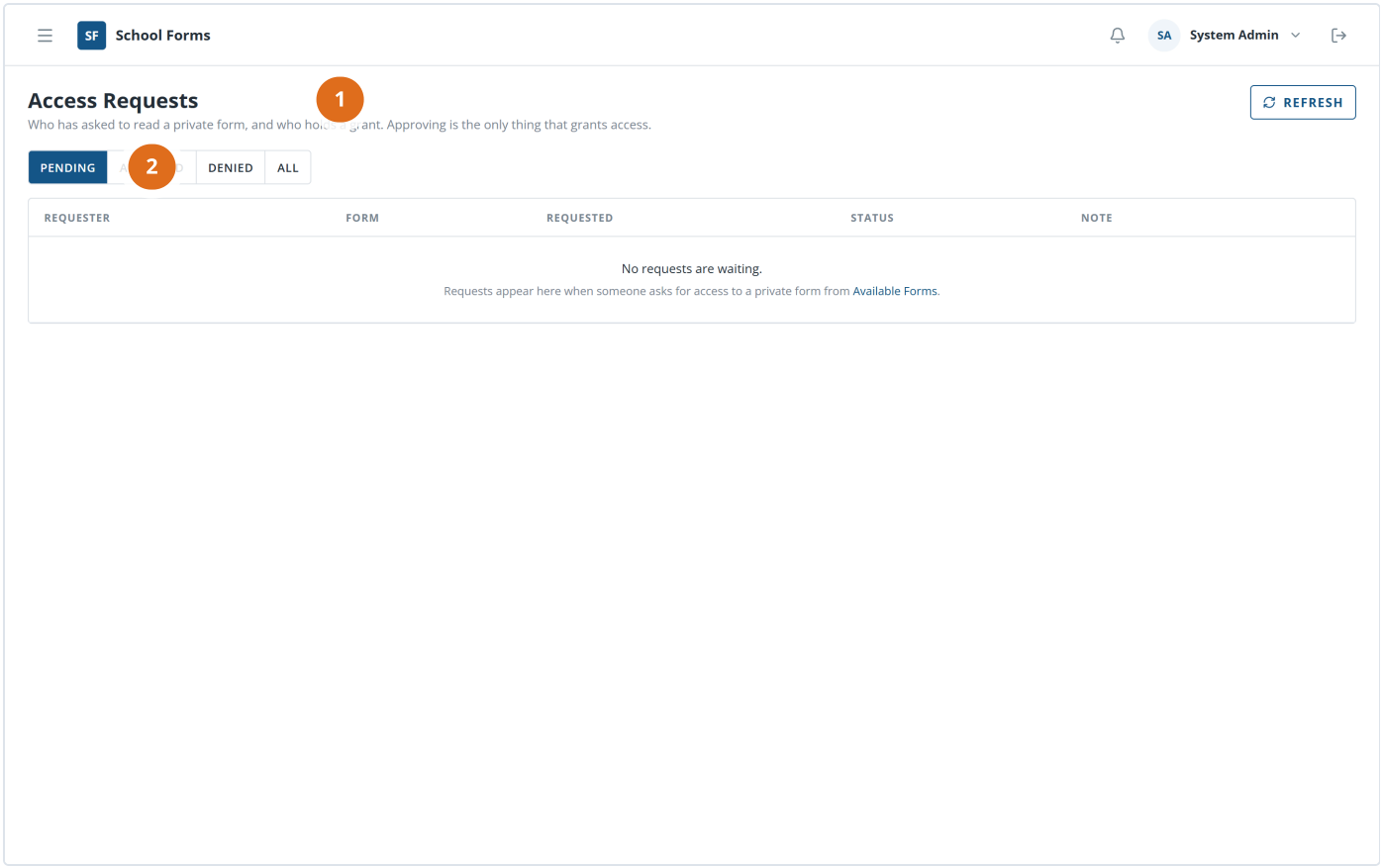


Figure 13 — Access requests.

1. The page heading, with the count of pending requests.
2. The decision controls on a request: approve it, or decline it with an optional reason that the requester will see.

Each row names who asked, for which form, and when.

> **Approving is the same as ticking the box**
>
> An approval creates the same grant you would create by ticking the form in **Settings** → **Users** → **Edit User**. Either route works; this one is just faster when several people are waiting. A declined request stays re-requestable — the person can ask again.

5. Reports and export

5.1 Building a report

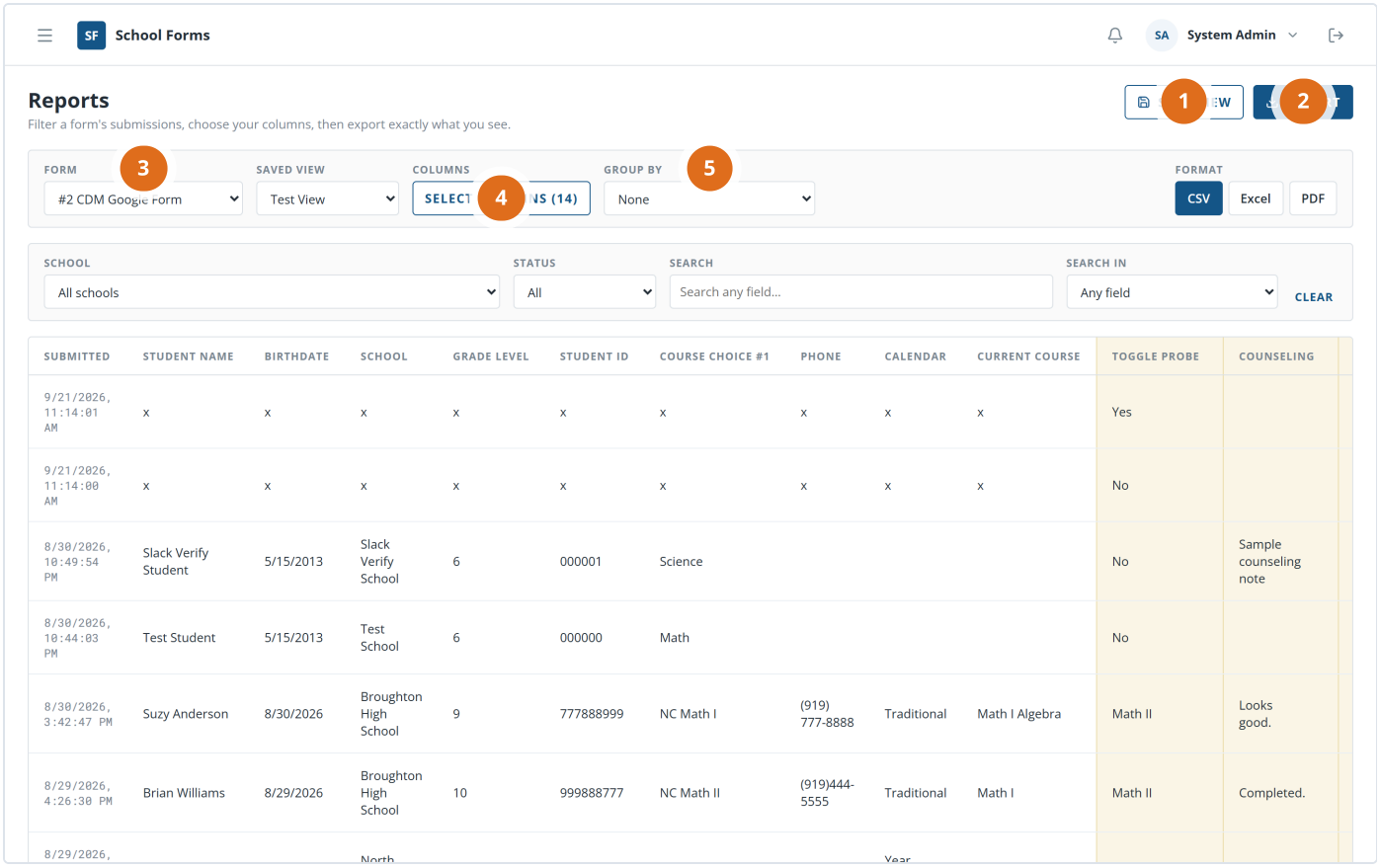


Figure 14 — The Reports page.

1. **Save View** — keep the filters and columns under a name.
2. **Export** — download in the chosen format.
3. **Form** — required; the columns belong to the form you pick.
4. **Select Columns** — see 5.2.
5. **Group by**; **Format** (CSV, Excel, PDF) sits to its right.

Below these sit **Saved View**, **School**, **Status**, **Search** and **Search in**. You have a School filter; a School Contact does not.

1. Pick a **Form**.
2. Narrow the rows with **School**, **Status** and **Search**.
3. Choose columns and, optionally, a **Group by**.
4. Pick a **Format** and click **Export**.

> **What you see is what you get**
>
> The preview and the exported file come from the same query, so the file always matches the screen. Saved views are private to the account that made them.

5.2 Selecting columns

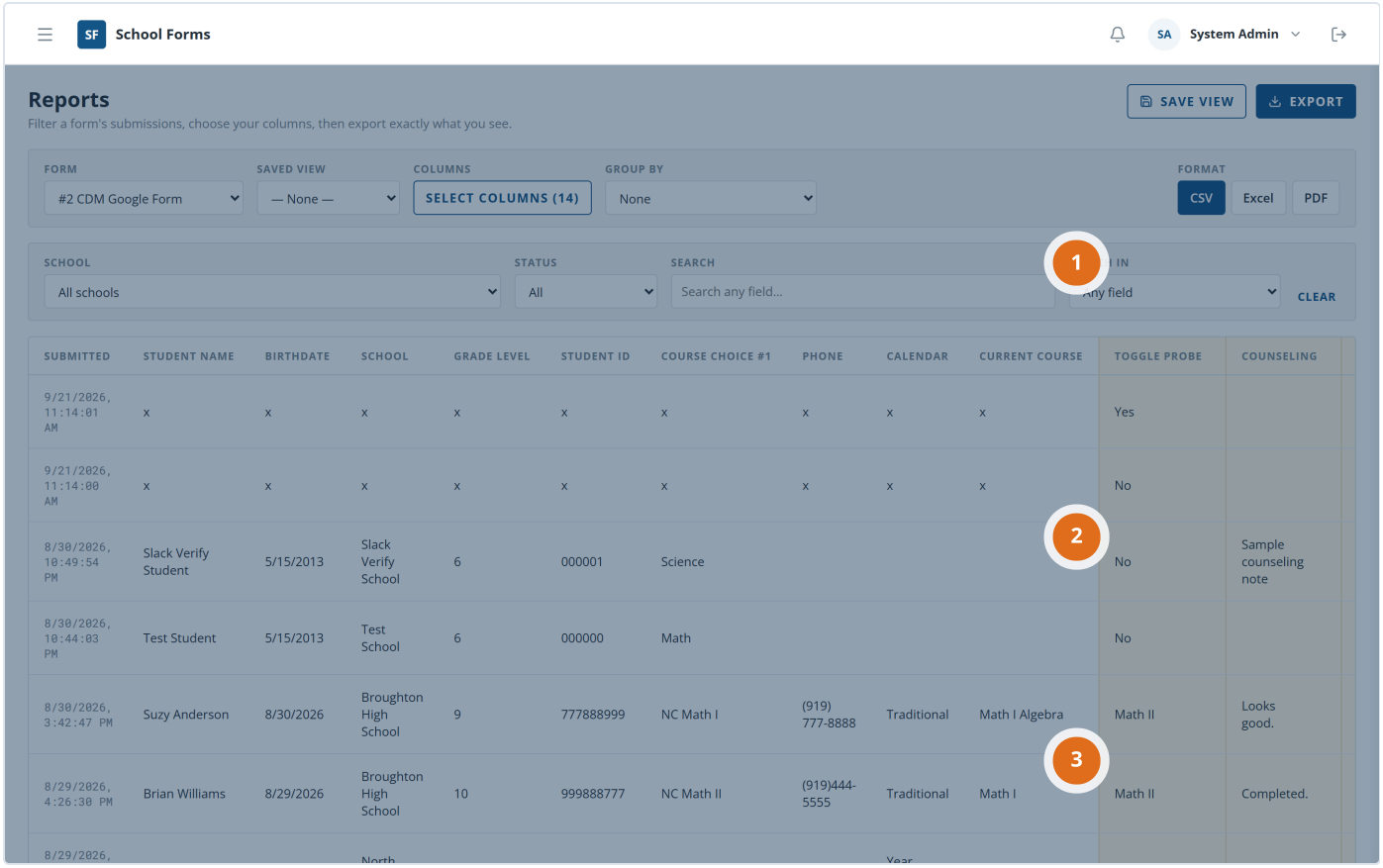


Figure 15 — Choosing report columns.

1. Tick the fields to show and export.
2. Staff-only fields are in the same list.
3. The footer counts your selection; **Done** closes the drawer.

6. Webhook Log

The Webhook Log is the answer to "a form looks empty — did anything actually arrive?" It lists every response Google Forms posted to the app, *including the ones it rejected*.

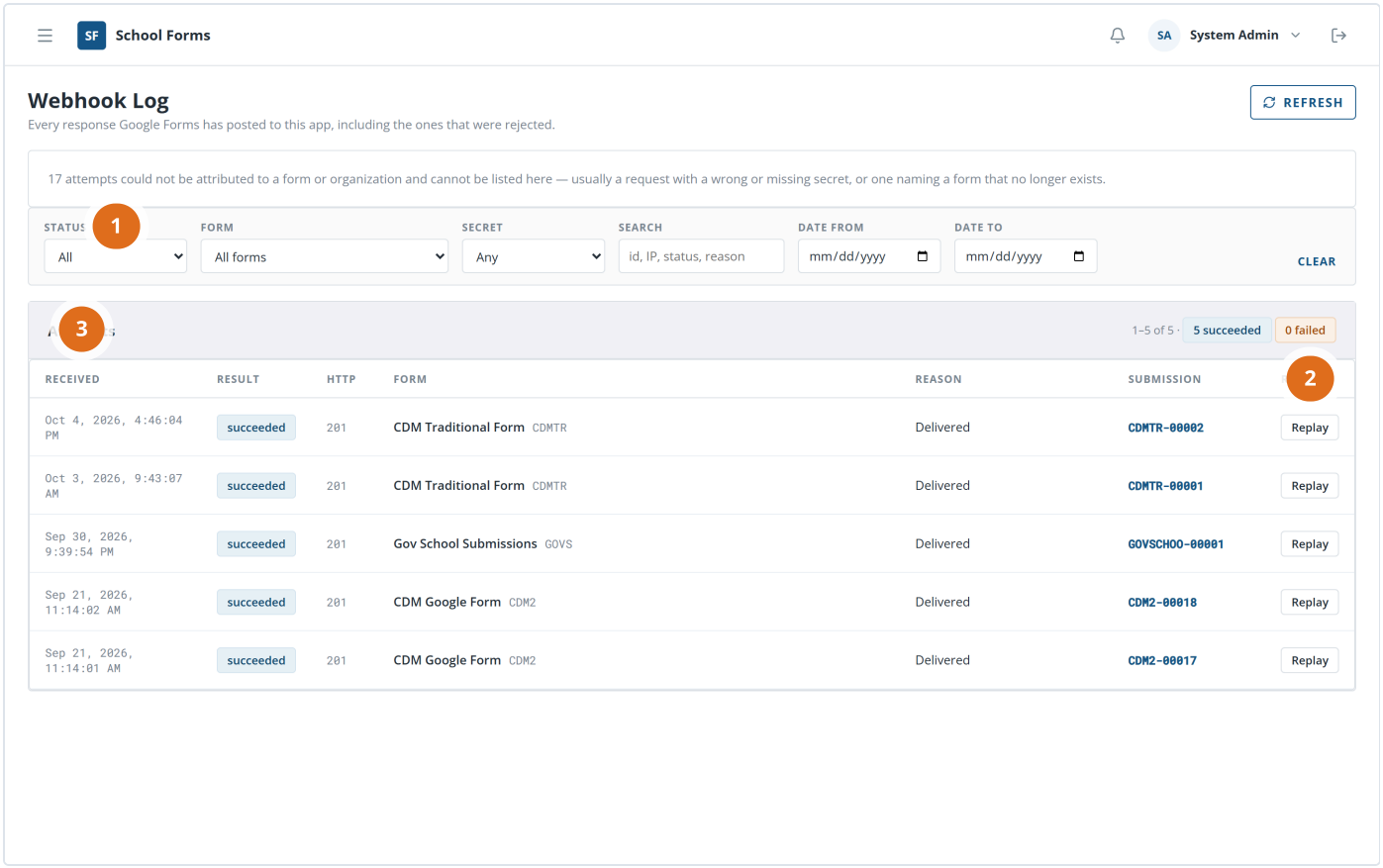


Figure 16 — The Webhook Log.

1. The **Status** filter — set it to **Failed** to see what was rejected.
2. **Replay** re-sends a stored response through today's rules. It is greyed out when the attempt cannot be replayed.
3. The **Attempts** table — one row per attempt, with its reason. Click a row for the full payload.

REASON	MEANING	REPLAYABLE?
Succeeded	Accepted; a submission was created.	—
`form_not_published`	The form was not published when the response arrived.	Yes, once published
`invalid_body`	The payload was missing required keys.	No
`form_not_found`	The form id does not exist.	No
`unauthorized`	Wrong or missing secret. Logged without the payload.	No
`internal_error`	The server failed.	Yes

The common case

If responses stopped arriving because a form was unpublished, publish the form and click **Replay** on the affected rows — or **Replay all failed** once a form is selected. The stored responses are re-sent and the submissions appear.

7. Generated Documents

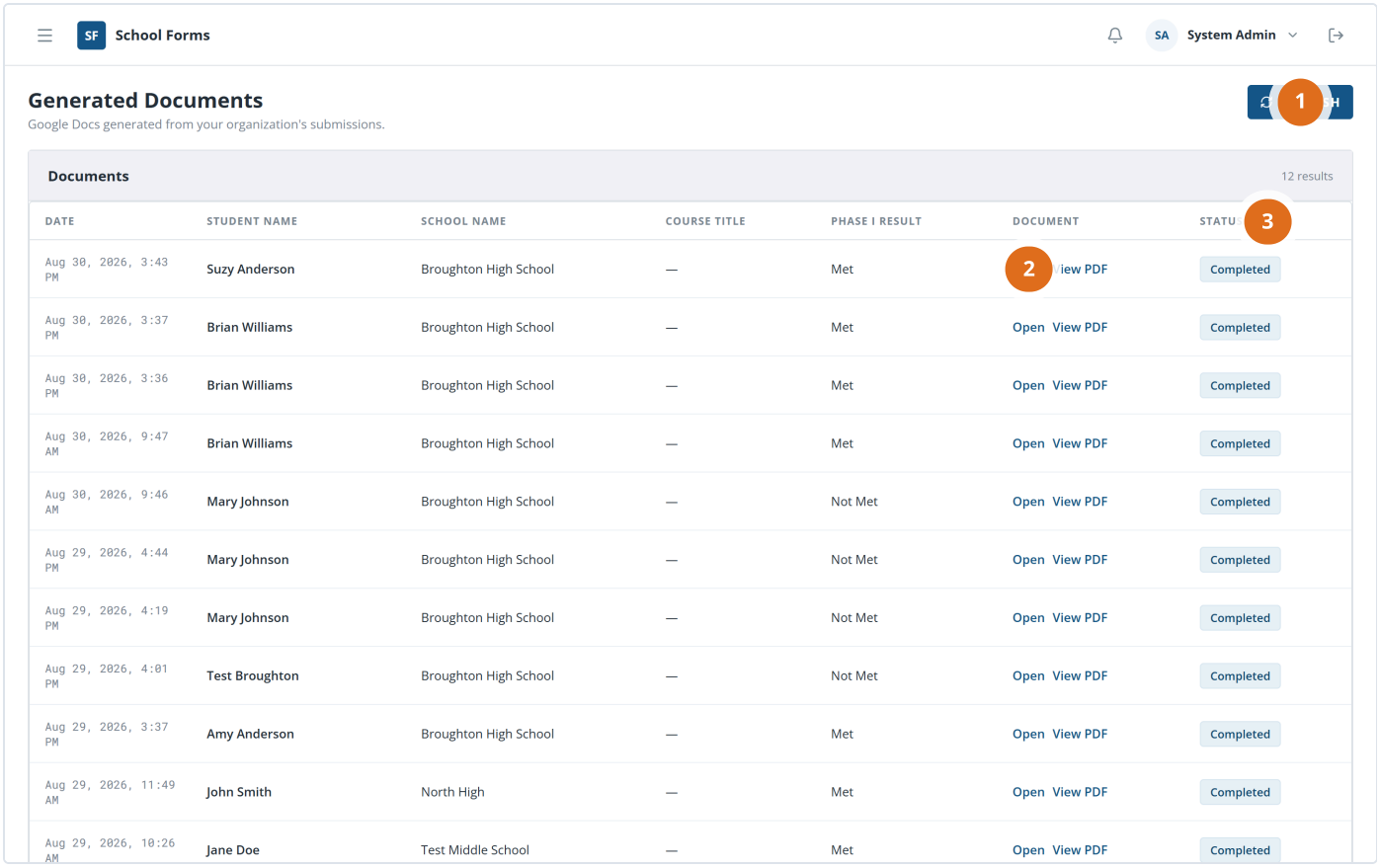


Figure 17 — Generated documents.

1. **Refresh** — reload, useful while a document is still being made.
2. **Open** opens the Google Doc; **View PDF** previews it here.
3. The **Status** column — **Pending**, **Completed** or **Failed**. A failed document can be retried from its submission.

This page appears in the menu only when **Settings → Documents Link** enables it for your role.

8. Your account

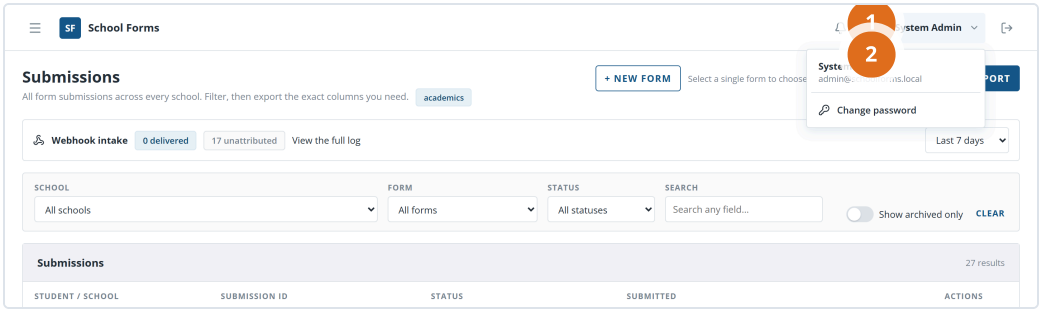


Figure 18 — The account menu.

1. Your name in the banner. Click it to open the menu.
2. **Change password** — you must enter your current password, then the new one twice. It must be at least 8 characters.

> **Changing your password does not sign out other sessions**
>
> Copies of School Forms already open elsewhere stay signed in. If you think someone else is using your account, change the password and review **Settings** → **Users**.

9. Reference

9.1 Status meanings

STATUS	APPLIES TO	MEANING
Submitted	Submissions	Received, awaiting review.
In Review	Submissions	Someone is working on it.
Flagged	Submissions	Needs attention or follow-up.
Completed	Submissions	Reviewed and finished.
Draft	Forms	Not yet available to parents.
Published	Forms	Live and accepting submissions.
Archived	Forms	Retired. Kept, but no longer accepting.
Pending	Documents	Being generated.
Failed	Documents	Generation failed; can be retried.

9.2 Field types

TYPE	USE FOR
Text	A short single-line answer.
Text Area	A longer, multi-line answer.
Number	A numeric value.
Date	A calendar date.
Email	An email address.
Google Document	A Drive file id, shown as a link that opens the file.
Select	A dropdown of options.
Radio	One choice from a short list.
Checkbox	One or more choices from a list.
Toggle	An on/off switch storing **Yes** or **No**.

9.3 Where to go next

I WANT TO…	GO TO
Add a user, change a role, reset a password	Settings Reference, chapter 2
Switch sign-in to password mode, or turn on maintenance	Settings Reference, chapter 3
Hide a menu item from a role	Settings Reference, chapter 5
Post a notice to everyone	Settings Reference, chapter 8
Fix a school name that does not match	Settings Reference, chapter 12
Understand what staff see and do	Staff Guide